

Original Policy Adopted by the Troop Committee on November 1, 2017

Revisions Adopted by the Troop Committee on December 7, 2022

SCOUT ACCOUNT AND SCOUT SUBSIDY POLICIES

Troop 75 is committed to help all of its Scouts and Troop families experience all that Scouting has to offer. To accomplish this, Troop 75 has implemented the following policies to assist scouts meet the financial burden of scouting activities.

1. Scout Accounts

In order to better track fundraising and other monies allocated for a scout's scouting adventure, the Troop Treasurer will create Scout Accounts for each active youth member of the Troop. A Scout's individual Scout Account may be funded with:

1. Scout Subsidy (discussed below in #2)
2. Individual Fundraising Proceeds (e.g. BSA Popcorn, etc.)
3. High Adventure Crew Fundraising Proceeds

2. Scout Subsidy

Each scouting year, the Troop Treasurer, with consultation from the PLC and Scoutmasters, will recommend to the Troop Committee a Scout Subsidy. The amount may vary from year to year based on the Troop's financial position and taking into account the Troop activities planned for the scouting year. In years where a Scout Subsidy is budgeted, the Scout Subsidy will be funded into each eligible scout's Scout Account after the Troop's primary fundraising event (i.e. Sportsmart).

There is no guarantee that a Scout Subsidy will be budgeted in any given year. Funds from the Troop's Rainy Day Reserve Fund may not be used for the Scout Subsidy.

IMPLEMENTATION GUIDELINES

Rationales:

1. Gives families who might not otherwise be able to afford scouting a chance to experience it.
2. Teaches scouts to be thrifty (“earning their way”) as well as manage their personal finances

BSA, Troop 75’s Charter Organization and Troop 75 Overarching Considerations:

1. Both the BSA and the Troop’s Charter Organization (i.e. Delmar Reformed Church) have a nonprofit status. Any funds CANNOT have “substantial private benefit” (i.e. spent on anything unrelated to scouting). Funds must “benefit the entire unit”. A Troop benefit would be to offset the costs of scouting (e.g. attending summer camp, Scout Jamboree, BSA High Adventure, NOAC, resident trainings such as NAYLE & NYLT, etc.).
2. Troop 75’s Charter Organization (i.e. Delmar Reformed Church) “owns” Troop 75 and thus “owns” its funds/equipment. Therefore, funds in a Scout Account cannot be transferred to the private accounts of the Scout and/or their family. Similarly, these funds may not be transferred to another Scouting unit (e.g. should a Troop 75 scout transfer to a different unit) that has a different Charter Organization than Troop 75’s.
3. The Troop Committee / Troop Treasurer is responsible for the Troop’s funds.
4. The Troop Committee can use Troop funds to assist/award individual scouts based on their participation in activities that benefit the Troop, Charter Organization and/or the Community

Rules:

1. The adult leaders for High Adventure crews as well as individual fundraising must provide all funds raised to the Troop Treasurer for deposit, together with a written report detailing into which Scout Account(s) said funds are to be deposited, and in which amounts. A copy of this written report shall be provided to the Troop Committee Chair as well. Funds will be maintained at the Scout Account level rather than on a High Adventure Crew (e.g. Philmont) or group individual fundraising (e.g. BSA Popcorn) level.
2. Scouts and their families may not make any deposits of their personal funds to their Scout Accounts since the Troop, not the Scout/family, owns the Scout Account.
3. If a scout leaves Troop 75 (e.g. transfer to another unit, age-out, etc.), funds in their Scout Account revert to the Troop’s general fund. If the departing Scout returns to Troop 75, they cannot recover their foregone funds from their Scout Account.

4. Scout Account disbursements can only be made for resident scouting events (i.e. not for Troop 75 camping trips/activities) and transportation to these events (e.g. airfare for a High Adventure Trip). Scouts Accounts may not be used to purchase goods (e.g. gear) or food. Exceptions to these permitted disbursements may only be approved by a consensus of the Charter Organization Representative, Troop Committee Chair, and the scout's respective Scoutmaster. Their decision is final.
5. Any request for the permitted disbursement of funds from a Scout Account shall be submitted in writing by the scout's parent or guardian to the Troop Treasurer with a copy to the Troop Committee Chair. The request shall contain directions of when to disburse, to whom to disburse, how much to disburse, as well as the purpose of the disbursement.
6. Since Scouts are to be thrifty (i.e. earn their way), to qualify for Scout Subsidy as well as Supplemental Scout Subsidy each year, the Scout must be registered and active (i.e. works at Sportsmart). If there are extenuating circumstances of why a Scout was not active at Sportsmart (e.g. illness), a consensus of the Charter Organization Representative, Troop Committee Chair, and the scout's respective Scoutmaster can deem that the scout should qualify for Scout Subsidy. Their decision is final.
7. The Troop Committee, as part of its annual budget process, will determine the amount of Scout Subsidy, if any.
8. Scouts are not required to draw down their Scout Account balance each year; Scout Accounts can accumulate funds for a future Scouting purpose. Troop 75 advises scout families from maintaining large account balances (e.g. >\$1k) unless the Scout is saving for a High Adventure trip, NAYLE, NOAC or National/World Jamboree since the Scout forfeits unused Scout Account monies upon aging out / leaving the Troop.
9. Scouts and their parents/guardians can request in writing to the Troop Treasurer with a copy to the Troop Committee Chair the transfer of funds in their Scout Account to a sibling's individual Scout Account. Scout families may NOT transfer their Scout Account balance to another Troop 75 family's Scout Account.
10. Any dispute on Scout Accounts will be resolved by the consensus of the Charter Organization Representative, Troop Committee Chair and the scout's respective Scoutmaster. Their decision is final.
11. The Troop reserves the right to change any of the above rules, including ending the Scout Subsidy, eliminating any Scout Account or eliminating part or all of this policy at any time it may deem appropriate, upon majority vote of the Troop Committee.